

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF KINGS

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SHAKEBA JONES,

Plaintiff, **SUMMONS TO THE VERIFIED  
COMPLAINT**

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK; DET. SAMUEL LALLAVA, Tax # 894731; DET. EDWARD NAJARRO, Shield # 4674 and Tax # 945431; SGT. CHRISTOPHER THOMAS, Tax # 926370; UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER 115; UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER 239; and P.O. JOHN DOES # 1-5 the individual defendant(s) sued individually and in their official capacities,

**Index:**

Basis of Venue: occurrence of incident Van Siclen and Jamaica Avenues, Brooklyn, New York

Defendants.

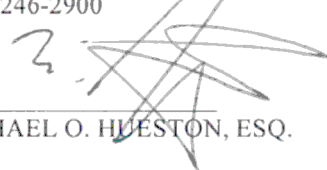
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To the above named defendants:

**You are hereby summoned** to answer the complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your answer or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the plaintiff's attorney within twenty days after service of this summons exclusive of the day of service where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or within thirty days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: Brooklyn, New York  
September 24, 2018

MICHAEL O. HUESTON, ESQ.  
*Attorney for Plaintiff*  
16 Court Street, Suite 1800  
Brooklyn, New York 11241  
(718) 246-2900

By: 

MICHAEL O. HUESTON, ESQ.

Defendants' addresses: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, 100 Church Street, New York, New York 10007; DET. SAMUEL LALLAVA, Tax # 894731; DET. EDWARD NAJARRO, Shield # 4674 and Tax # 945431; SGT. CHRISTOPHER THOMAS, Tax # 926370; UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER 115; UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER 239; and P.O. JOHN DOES # 1-5, Narcotics Borough Brooklyn North, 79 Wilson Ave, Brooklyn, New York 11237, 75<sup>th</sup> Precinct, 1000 Sutter Ave, Brooklyn, NY 11208, and/or One Police Plaza, New York, New York 10007

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF KINGS

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Plaintiff, **VERIFIED COMPLAINT**

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926370; UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER 115;  
UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER 239; and P.O. JOHN  
DOES # 1-5 the individual defendant(s) sued individually and  
in their official capacities,

Basis of Venue: occurrence of  
incident Van Siclen and Jamaica  
Avenues, Brooklyn, New York

**Jury Trial Demanded**

Defendants.

-----X

Plaintiff, Shakeba Jones, by and through her counsel, Michael Hueston, Esq., and  
Andrew S. Rendeiro, Esq. upon information and belief, alleges as follows:

**PRELIMINARY STATEMENT**

1. This is a civil rights, common law, and tort action in which plaintiff seeks relief for the violation of plaintiff's rights secured by 42 U.S.C. § 1983; and the Fourth, Sixth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution; and the laws of the State of New York. Plaintiff's claims arise from an incident that arose on or about April 18, 2017 through on or about July 17, 2017. During the incident, the City of New York, and members of the New York City Police Department ("NYPD") subjected plaintiff to, among other things: false arrest; unreasonable force; failure to intervene; conspiracy; malicious prosecution; denial of a fair trial/fabricated evidence; implementation and continuation of an unlawful municipal policy, practice, and custom; and respondeat superior liability. Plaintiff seeks compensatory and

punitive damages, declaratory relief, an award of costs and attorney's fees, pursuant 42 U.S.C. § 1988, and such other and further relief as the Court deems just and proper.

### **JURISDICTION & VENUE**

2. Within 90 days of the incident alleged in this complaint, plaintiff served upon defendant City of New York a Notice of Claim (regarding the malicious prosecution claim) setting forth the name and post office addresses of plaintiff, the nature of the claims, the time when, the place where and the manner in which the claims arose, and the items of damages or injuries claimed.

3. More than 30 days have elapsed since plaintiff's demands and/or claims were presented to defendant City of New York for adjustment and/or payment thereof, and the defendant has neglected and/or refused to make any adjustment and/or payment.

4. Plaintiff has satisfied all conditions precedent for the filing of this action. This action is being commenced within one year and ninety days of the date of the occurrence herein.

5. Venue is proper in the Supreme Court of the State New York, Kings County, because the acts in question occurred in the State of New York, Kings County, and the City of New York is subject to personal jurisdiction in Supreme Court of the State New York, Kings County; and jurisdiction is proper because the Supreme Court of the State New York, Kings County has jurisdiction over plaintiff's state law causes of actions, and plaintiff's federal causes of action pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1983.

### **PARTIES**

6. Plaintiff Shakeba Jones is a resident of the State of New York, living at 323 Jamaica Avenue, Brooklyn, New York 11207.

7. At all times herein, defendant City of New York is a municipal corporation organized under the laws of the State of New York, which violated plaintiff's rights as described herein.

8. At all times relevant, defendant City of New York maintained a police department known as the NYPD, which employed the individual defendants.

9. At all times alleged herein, defendants police officers, including Det. Samuel Lallava, Tax # 894731; Det. Edward Najarro, Shield # 4674 and Tax # 945431; Sgt. Christopher Thomas, Tax # 926370; Undercover Police Officer 115; Undercover Police Officer 239; and P.O. John Does # 1-5, were employed as police officers with Narcotics Borough Brooklyn North, and/or 75<sup>th</sup> Precinct, located in Kings County, New York, or other as yet unknown NYPD assignment, who violated plaintiff's rights as described herein.

10. The individual defendants are sued in their individual and official capacities.

### **STATEMENT OF FACTS**

#### **The Incident**

11. On April 18, 2017, at and in the vicinity of Van Siclen and Jamaica Avenues, Brooklyn, New York, several police officers operating with Narcotics Borough Brooklyn North Command, located in Kings County, New York, including upon information and belief, the individual defendants Det. Samuel Lallava, Tax # 894731; Det. Edward Najarro, Shield # 4674 and Tax # 945431; Sgt. Christopher Thomas, Tax # 926370; Undercover Police Officer 115; Undercover Police Officer 239; and P.O. John Does # 1-5 ("the police"), at times acting in concert and at times acting independently, committed the following illegal acts against plaintiff.

12. On April 18, 2017 at approximately 3:00 p.m., at and in the vicinity of Van Siclen and Jamaica Avenues, Brooklyn, New York, the police without either consent, an arrest warrant, a lawful search warrant, probable cause, or reasonable suspicion that plaintiff (or any third person) had committed a crime unlawfully arrested plaintiff.

13. The police acted in concert in committing the above-described illegal acts against plaintiff.

14. Plaintiff was working on her home, and had left to go to a grocery store with an acquaintance.

15. Plaintiff saw another acquaintance from the neighborhood and they spoke.

16. As plaintiff was saying goodbye, the police approached plaintiff and the other individuals.

17. Once the police approached, plaintiff was not free to disregard the defendants' questions, walk away or leave the scene.

18. The police searched plaintiff and found no contraband.

19. The police placed plaintiff in handcuffs.

20. The police manhandled plaintiff.

21. The police placed plaintiff in handcuffs that were excessively tight.

22. Plaintiff's requests to the police to loosen the handcuffs were ignored.

23. The handcuffs left marks and bruises on plaintiffs' wrists.

24. The police pushed plaintiff into a police vehicle, causing her head to strike the car.

25. The police injured plaintiff's finger.

26. The police were abusive and rude to plaintiff.

27. The police found no basis to arrest to plaintiff.

28. Nevertheless, the police transported plaintiff to the 75<sup>th</sup> Precinct where her arrest was processed.

29. The police took plaintiff's personal property.

30. At the 75<sup>th</sup> Precinct, plaintiff was stripped searched without cause.

31. The police transported plaintiff to Brooklyn Central Booking for arraignment.

32. In order to cover up their illegal actions, the police, including Det. Samuel Lallava, Tax # 894731; Det. Edward Najarro, Shield # 4674 and Tax # 945431; Sgt. Christopher Thomas, Tax # 926370; Undercover Police Officer 115; and Undercover Police Officer 239, pursuant to a conspiracy, initiated by false sworn complaint(s) and/or conversations, falsely and maliciously told the Kings County District Attorney's Office that plaintiff had committed various crimes, and the District Attorney prosecuted plaintiff.

33. Plaintiff was released at arraignment on her own recognizance.

34. All criminal charges against plaintiff were dismissed on July 17, 2017, and the criminal case against plaintiff terminated in plaintiff's favor.

35. Plaintiff was humiliated and embarrassed by the experience.

36. Plaintiff suffered a post arraignment restraint on her liberty.

37. Plaintiff suffered financial loss.

### **General Allegations**

38. Plaintiff did not resist arrest at any time during the above-described incidents.

39. Plaintiff did not violate any law, regulation, or administrative code; commit any criminal act; or act in a suspicious or unlawful manner prior to or during the above-described incident.

40. The individual defendants did not observe plaintiff violate any law, regulation, or administrative code; commit any criminal act; or act in a suspicious or unlawful manner prior to or during the above-described incident.

41. The individual defendants acted under pretense and color of state law and their individual and official capacities and within the scope of their employment. Said acts by said defendants were beyond the scope of their jurisdiction, without authority or law, and in abuse of their powers, and said defendants acted willfully, knowingly, and with the specific intent to deprive plaintiff of her rights.

42. As a direct and proximate result of defendants' actions, plaintiff experienced personal and physical injuries, pain and suffering, fear, an invasion of privacy, psychological pain, emotional distress, mental anguish, embarrassment, humiliation, and financial loss.

43. Plaintiff is entitled to receive punitive damages from the individual defendants because the individual defendants' actions were motivated by extreme recklessness and indifference to plaintiff's rights.

#### **FIRST CLAIM**

#### **(FALSE ARREST UNDER FEDERAL LAW)**

44. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.



45. Defendants falsely arrested plaintiff without consent, an arrest warrant, probable cause, or reasonable suspicion that plaintiff had committed a crime.

46. Accordingly, defendants are liable to plaintiff for false arrest under 42 U.S.C. § 1983; and the Fourth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

**SECOND CLAIM**

**(UNREASONABLE FORCE)**

47. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

48. The individual defendants' use of force upon plaintiff was objectively unreasonable.

49. The individual defendant officers did not have an objective and/or reasonable basis to use any degree of force against plaintiff.

50. Those defendants who did not touch plaintiff, witnessed these acts, but failed to intervene and protect plaintiff from this conduct.

51. Accordingly, the defendants are liable to plaintiff for using unreasonable force, pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1983; and the Fourth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

**THIRD CLAIM**

**(FAILURE TO INTERVENE)**

52. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

53. Defendants had a reasonable opportunity to prevent the violations of plaintiff's constitutional rights, but they failed to intervene.



54. Accordingly, the defendants are liable to plaintiff for failing to intervene to prevent the violation of plaintiff's constitutional rights under 42 U.S.C. § 1983; and the Fourth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

**FOURTH CLAIM**

**(CONSPIRACY)**

55. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

56. Defendants are liable to plaintiff because they agreed to act in concert to inflict an unconstitutional injury; and committed an overt act done in furtherance of that goal causing damage to plaintiff under 42 U.S.C. § 1983.

**FIFTH CLAIM**

**(MALICIOUS PROSECUTION FEDERAL LAW)**

57. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

58. The individual defendants are liable to plaintiff for malicious prosecution because, pursuant to a conspiracy and acting with malice, the defendants initiated a malicious prosecution(s) against plaintiff by knowingly, intentionally, and maliciously providing false statements in complaints and police reports to police officers, prosecutors and/or the court(s), which alleged plaintiff had committed various crimes.

59. The individual defendants lacked probable cause to believe the above-stated malicious prosecution could succeed.

60. The individual defendants initiated the above-stated malicious prosecution to cover up their illegal and unconstitutional conduct.

61. The above-stated malicious prosecution caused a sufficient post-arraignment liberty restraint on plaintiff.

**SIXTH CLAIM**

**(MALICIOUS PROSECUTION STATE LAW)**

62. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

63. The individual defendants are liable to plaintiff for malicious prosecution because, pursuant to a conspiracy and acting with malice, the defendants initiated a malicious prosecution(s) against plaintiff by knowingly, intentionally, and maliciously providing false statements in complaints and police reports to police officers, prosecutors and/or the court(s), which alleged plaintiff had committed various crimes.

64. The individual defendants lacked probable cause to believe the above-stated malicious prosecution could succeed.

65. The individual defendants initiated the above-stated malicious prosecution to cover up their illegal and unconstitutional conduct.

**SEVENTH CLAIM**

**(DENIAL OF A FAIR TRIAL/FABRICATION OF EVIDENCE)**

66. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

67. The individual defendants are liable to plaintiff because they intentionally conspired to fabricate evidence against plaintiff, including omitting and/or manipulating evidence, and suppressing exculpatory evidence and forwarded that false evidence to police officers, prosecutors, and the court.

68. The individual defendants violated the law by either testifying falsely, providing false information, and/or drafting and signing false criminal court complaints and/or false police reports and forwarding them to police officers, prosecutors and the court.

69. The individual defendants were on notice that creating fabricated evidence is a clear violation of law because it is well established that individuals who knowingly use false evidence to obtain a conviction act unconstitutionally, depriving plaintiff of liberty without due process of law or a fair trial, and the harm occasioned by such unconscionable actions are redressable in an action for damages under 42 U.S.C. § 1983, the Fair Trial Clause of the Sixth Amendment to the United States Constitution, and the Due Process Clause of the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

**EIGHTH CLAIM**

**(MONELL CLAIM)**

70. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

71. Defendant City of New York, through a policy, practice and custom, directly caused the constitutional violations suffered by plaintiffs.

72. Defendant City of New York through the NYPD and its officers and agents, committed the following unconstitutional practices, customs and policies against plaintiffs: (1) arresting innocent persons in order to meet productivity goals and without cause; (2) using unreasonable force on individuals; and (3) fabricating evidence against innocent persons.

73. Upon information and belief, defendant City of New York, at all relevant times, was aware that the defendants were unfit officers who have previously committed the acts alleged herein, have a propensity for unconstitutional conduct, or have been inadequately trained.

74. Nevertheless, defendant City of New York exercised deliberate indifference by failing to take remedial action. The City failed to properly train, retrain, supervise, discipline, and monitor the individual defendants and improperly retained and utilized them. Moreover, upon information and belief, defendant City of New York failed to adequately investigate prior complaints filed against the individual defendants.

75. Further, defendant City of New York was aware prior to the incident that the individual defendants (in continuation of its illegal custom, practice and/or policy) would stop, arrest and prosecute innocent individuals, based on pretexts and false evidence.

76. The existence of the aforesaid unconstitutional customs and policies may be inferred from repeated occurrences of similar wrongful conduct involving the individual defendants, placing the defendant City of New York on notice of the individual defendants' propensity to violate the rights of individuals.

77. The foregoing customs, policies, usages, practices, procedures and rules of the City of New York and the NYPD were the moving force behind the constitutional violations suffered by plaintiffs as alleged herein.

78. The City's failure to act resulted in the violation of plaintiff's constitutional rights as described herein.

**NINTH CLAIM****(RESPONDEAT SUPERIOR)**

79. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

80. The individual defendants were acting within the scope of their employment when they committed the above described acts against plaintiff, including maliciously prosecuting plaintiff.

81. The City of New York is therefore vicariously liable under New York State law for the aforesaid torts.

**WHEREFORE**, plaintiff demands a jury trial and the following relief jointly and severally against the defendants; and demands judgment and compensatory damages, individually and/or collectively in an amount that exceeds the jurisdiction of all lower courts that would otherwise have jurisdiction as to the above-stated cause of action against all defendants; punitive damages in an amount to be determined at trial as and for the above-stated causes of action against the individual defendants; together with costs and disbursements of this action and legal fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

DATED: Brooklyn, New York  
September 24, 2018

MICHAEL O. HUESTON, ESQ.  
ANDREW S. RENDEIRO, ESQ.  
*Attorney for Plaintiff*  
16 Court Street, Suite 1800  
Brooklyn, New York 11241  
(718) 246-2900  
mhueston@nyc.rr.com  
By:

  
MICHAEL O. HUESTON, ESQ.

VERIFICATION

I, Shakeba Jones, state under the oath, that I am the deponent in this action, and that I have read the Verified Complaint and that it is true to the knowledge of the deponent, except as to matters, alleged on information and belief, and that as to those matters I believe it to be true.

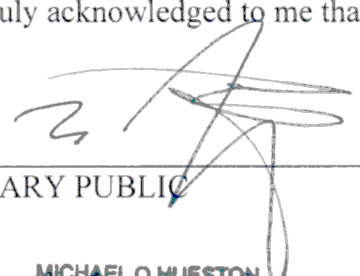
  
Shakeba Jones

STATE OF NEW YORK )

: ss:

COUNTY OF KINGS )

On the 24<sup>th</sup> day of September, 2018, before me personally came and appeared SHAKEBA JONES to me known and known to me to be the individual described in and who executed the foregoing instrument, and who duly acknowledged to me that he executed the same.

  
NOTARY PUBLIC

MICHAEL O HUESTON  
Notary Public, State of New York  
No. 02HU6073603  
Qualified in Kings County  
Commission Expires April 22, 2022



Index No.

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
KINGS COUNTY

SHAKEBA JONES,

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-against-

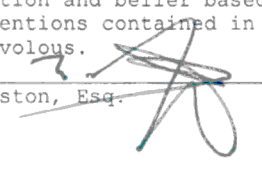
CITY OF NEW YORK, et al.,

Defendants.

**SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT**

MICHAEL HUESTON, ESQ.  
ANDREW S. RENDEIRO, ESQ.  
*Attorney for Plaintiff*  
16 Court St., Suite 1800  
Brooklyn, New York 11241  
(718) 246-2900

Pursuant to 22 NYCRR 130-1.1, the undersigned, an attorney duly admitted to practice law in the State of New York, certifies that, upon information and belief based upon reasonable inquiry, the contentions contained in the annexed document are not frivolous.

Dated: 9/24/2018 Signature: 

Michael Hueston, Esq.

*Due and timely, service is hereby  
admitted.*

Brooklyn, New York....., 2018

....., Esq.

Attorney for.....